



Research Assessment – the international reform discussions, and DFG's position

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Contents

1. Background: International reform initiatives
2. DFG White Paper „Academic Publishing“ and policy measures 2022
3. The Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA)



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Background: International initiatives to reform research assessment

► *San Francisco Declaration on Research Assessment*

(DORA, 2012, <https://sfdora.org/>)

Declaration originating from the Annual Meeting of the American Society for Cell Biology

18 proposals, directed at different groups (funders, institutions, publishers, data service providers, researchers)



DORA

nature

International weekly journal of science

Bibliometrics: The Leiden Manifesto



► *Leiden Manifesto for Research Metrics* (2015,

<http://www.leidenmanifesto.org/>)

10 proposals against inappropriate uses of quantitative (mainly bibliometrical) data for purposes of research assessment (on different levels)

► *Hong Kong Principles for Assessing Researchers* (2019,

<https://www.wcrif.org/guidance/hong-kong-principles>)



**WORLD CONFERENCES
ON RESEARCH INTEGRITY**

Adopted at the 6th World Conference on Research Integrity

Background: International initiatives to reform research assessment

Two main demands

Convergence on two main demands:

- ▶ For purposes of research assessment (esp. of research proposals and individual achievements, e.g. in tenure review) **qualitative approaches** should be prioritized over quantitative proxies like JIF, h index etc.
- ▶ For purposes of research assessment (esp. of research proposals and individual achievements), a broader **variety** of practices and contributions to science should count (not just journal articles)

Ideas instead of mere numbers
Diversity of research practices and types of contributions

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DFG White Paper on Academic Publishing ... and Research Assessment (May 2022)

Incentives on individual research



https://www.dfg.de/en/service/press/press_releases/2022/press_release_no_15/index.html

Research Assessment – the international reform discussions, and DFG's position

Disadvantages of a (mostly) prestige-driven publication culture

Problems and (a selection of) countermeasures

- **Delay** between conclusion of research and publication
- **Reduced public awareness**, visibility, findability of topics which are (currently) not „marketable“
- **Insufficient recognition** for scientific output of the non-prestigious kinds

**Impediments
to the flow of
(new) knowledge**

- Incentives for **cutting corners in research process** and hasty publication
- Incentives for **violations of good scientific practice**

**Loss of
scientific quality**

- **High cost** of publication (money for prestige)

Rising costs

Disadvantages of a (mostly) prestige-driven publication culture

Problems and (a selection of) countermeasures

- Establish and support fast, open publication formats (e.g. preprints)
- Equal access for all topics in reaching the academic public
- Scientific community as owner of data, publications and publication venues
- Recognition for all forms of scientific output

**Improve flow of
scientific knowledge**

Increase quality

Lower costs

Disadvantages of a (mostly) prestige-driven publication culture

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**Improve flow of
scientific knowledge**

→ **Open Science position paper:**
<https://zenodo.org/record/7193838#.Y3zS6qSZNaT>

- Incentivize quality control in the entire cycle of research
- Incentivize good scientific practice (e.g. via recognition for Open Science adherence)

→ **DFG code:** <https://wissenschaftliche-integritaet.de/en>

Increase quality

Lower costs

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**Improve flow of
scientific knowledge**

- Incentivize quality control in the entire cycle of research
- Incentivize good scientific practice (e.g. via recognition for Open Science adherence)

Increase quality

- Establish and support science-driven, affordable publication venues

Lower costs

→ Action Plan for Diamond Open Access: https://www.dfg.de/foerderung/info_wissenschaft/2022/info_wissenschaft_22_26/index.html
<https://zenodo.org/record/6282403#.Y3zTr6SZNaQ>

Disadvantages of a (mostly) prestige-driven publication culture

Problems and (a selection of) countermeasures

- Establish and support fast, open publication formats (e.g. preprints)
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**Improve flow of
scientific knowledge**

- Incentivize quality control in the entire cycle of research
- Incentivize good scientific practice (e.g. via recognition for Open Science adherence)

Increase quality

- Establish and support science driven, affordable publication venues

Lower costs

Requires a reform of research assessment!
- Ideas not metrics
- Appreciation of variety of outputs

DFG's measures to support a shift in the culture of research assessment

Sept. 2022

Assessment



https://www.dfg.de/en/research_funding/announcements_proposals/2022/info_wissenschaft_22_61/

DFG's measures to support a shift in the culture of research assessment

Since September 2022

Changes in the proposals and review procedures

→ <https://www.dfg.de/foerderung/index.html>

- Room for individual and narrative information
- New category for various forms of publication types
- Frugal in terms of data, GDPR compatible

uniform CV

- Discuss *contents* of project specific preliminary and previous works
 - List of previous publications only in the References (at the end of the text)
- Inclusion of full spectrum of publication formats
- No metrics!

new Guidelines

Einheitliches DFG Lebenslaufmuster ab 1.9.2022

Optionale narrative Elemente, Abbildung der ganzen Breite wissenschaftlicher Tätigkeit

Supplementary Career Information *optional; free text*

[free text, please overwrite]

Activities in the Research System *optional, free text*

Here you can provide information on other activities you have pursued within the research system. This includes committee involvement, activities in the field of academic self-governance, organisation of academic events, activities in teaching and mentoring.

[free text, please overwrite]

Curriculum Vitae [09/22]:

https://www.dfg.de/formulare/53_200_elan/53_200_de_elan.rtf

Supervision of Researchers in Early Career Phases *optional, free text*

Einheitliches DFG Lebenslaufmuster ab 1.9.2022

Zwei Kategorien zur Darstellung der ganzen Breite wissenschaftlicher Ergebnisse

Scientific Results *Part A required, Part B optional; free text*

Please indicate here your most important published scientific results (see also "Guidelines for Preparing Publication Lists", [DFG form 1.91](#)). If available, please also provide persistent identifiers (e.g. DOI/Digital Object Identifier), preferably by stating the number, otherwise by naming the URL. Open access publications should be designated accordingly.

Details of quantitative metrics such as impact factors and h-indices are not required and are not considered as part of the review.

Please also explain – where possible – how you were involved in the published findings and/or explain why you have listed the publication or the academic contribution here.

These details fall into two categories:

Category A *required, free text*

*In this category please enter articles in peer-reviewed journals, peer-reviewed contributions to conferences or anthology volumes, and book publications (see also [DFG form 1.91](#)). A **maximum of ten items** may be listed.*

[free text, please overwrite]

Category B *optional, free text*

*Here you can cite **any other form of published research results**. This might include articles on preprint servers and non-peer-reviewed contributions to conferences or anthology volumes, data sets, protocols of clinical trials, software packages, patents applied for and granted, blog contributions, infrastructures or transfer. You may also **indicate other forms of academic output** here, such as contributions to the (technical) infrastructure of an academic community (including in an international context) and contributions to science communication. **This second category is also restricted to a maximum of ten items.***

[free text, please overwrite]

Curriculum Vitae [09/22]:

https://www.dfg.de/formulare/53_200_elan/53_200_de_elan.rtf

Angepasste DFG Antragstellung ab 1.9.2022 (Sachbeihilfe)

Inhaltliche Darstellung der eigenen Arbeiten, **keine Listenform mehr**

1 Ausgangslage

Stand der Forschung und eigene Vorarbeiten

Legen Sie bei Neuanträgen den Stand der Forschung bitte knapp und präzise in seiner unmittelbaren Beziehung zum konkreten Vorhaben dar. In dieser Darstellung sollte deutlich werden, **wo Sie Ihre eigenen Arbeiten eingeordnet sehen und zu welchen der anstehenden Fragen Sie einen eigenen, neuen und weiterführenden Beitrag leisten wollen.**

Der aktuelle Stand der eigenen Vorarbeiten ist zu benennen. Die Darstellung muss ohne Hinzuziehen weiterer Literatur verständlich sein.

Leitfaden für die Antragstellung - Projektanträge [09/22]:
https://www.dfg.de/formulare/54_01/54_01_de.pdf

Änderungen in der DFG Begutachtung ab 1.9.2022

Ganze Breite wissenschaftlicher Betätigung würdigen, möglichst keine Metriken!

Die **Bewertung** der Leistung von Wissenschaftlerinnen und Wissenschaftlern muss in ihrer Gesamtheit und **auf der Grundlage inhaltlich-qualitativer Kriterien** erfolgen. Neben der Veröffentlichung von Artikeln, Büchern, Daten und Software können weitere Dimensionen Berücksichtigung finden, wie zum Beispiel Engagement in der Lehre, der akademischen Selbstverwaltung, der Öffentlichkeitsarbeit oder dem Wissens- und Technologietransfer. **Angaben zu quantitativen Metriken wie Impact-Faktoren und h-Indizes sind nicht erforderlich und sollen bei der Begutachtung nicht berücksichtigt werden.**

Merkblatt Allgemeine Hinweise für die Begutachtung [09/22]:
https://www.dfg.de/formulare/10_20/10_20_de.pdf

DFG-Maßnahmenpaket zum Wandel der wissenschaftlichen Bewertungskultur

September 2022

Information für die Wissenschaft Nr. 61 | 1.9.2022: **“Maßnahmenpaket zum Wandel der wissenschaftlichen Bewertungskultur“**
https://www.dfg.de/foerderung/info_wissenschaft/2022/info_wissenschaft_22_61/index.html

Einzelne Neuerungen

- Curriculum Vitae [09/22]: https://www.dfg.de/formulare/53_200_elan/53_200_de_elan.rtf
- Hinweise zu Publikationsverzeichnissen [09/22]: https://www.dfg.de/formulare/1_91/1_91_de.pdf
- Merkblatt Allgemeine Hinweise für die Begutachtung [09/22]: https://www.dfg.de/formulare/10_20/10_20_de.pdf
- Leitfaden für die Antragstellung - Projektanträge [09/22]: https://www.dfg.de/formulare/54_01/54_01_de.pdf
- Beschreibung des Vorhabens - Antragsskizze Forschungsgruppe [09/22]: https://www.dfg.de/formulare/53_20_elan/53_20_de_elan.rtf

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CoARA – the leading idea

Declarations are not enough.

Recommendations are not enough.

The actions of individual organisations are not enough.

We need coordinated action. We need a change of *culture*.

Agreement on Reforming Research Assessment

The „Commitments“

► Core Commitments

1. Recognise the diversity of contributions to, and careers in, research in accordance with the needs and nature of the research
2. Base research assessment primarily on qualitative evaluation for which peer review is central, supported by responsible use of quantitative indicators
3. Abandon inappropriate uses in research assessment of journal- and publication-based metrics, in particular inappropriate uses of Journal Impact Factor (JIF) and h-index
4. Avoid the use of rankings of research organisations in research assessment

general

specific

Agreement on Reforming Research Assessment

The „Commitments“

► Supporting Commitments

5. Commit resources to reforming research assessment as is needed to achieve the organisational changes committed to
6. Review and develop research assessment criteria, tools and processes
7. Raise awareness of research assessment reform and provide transparent communication, guidance, and training on assessment criteria and processes as well as their use
8. Exchange practices and experiences to enable mutual learning within and beyond the Coalition
9. Communicate progress made on adherence to the Principles and implementation of the Commitments
10. Evaluate practices, criteria and tools based on solid evidence and the state-of-the-art in research on research, and make data openly available for evidence gathering and research

each agency for itself

joint effort, with the
help of CoARA

Agreement on Reforming Research Assessment

The agreement is compatible with a number of key theses:

- ▶ Research quality („excellence“) is the main target of research assessment
- ▶ Diversity and inclusivity are (mainly, also) conditions for research quality
- ▶ „Impact“ can be understood intra-scientifically
- ▶ „Open“ in „open science“ can be understood as transparency, replicability, accessibility

Agreement online: <https://coara.eu/agreement/the-agreement-full-text/>

Agreement on Reforming Research Assessment

Why a Coalition (Co) for Advancing Research Assessment?

Not just an agreement, but a coalition – for what?

- ▶ **Exchange**
- ▶ **(Light) reporting**
- ▶ **Probably also: Agreement on CoARA „recommendations“**

CoARA: an organisation with...

- General Assembly
- Working Groups
- Steering Board, Chair and Co-Chairs
- National Chapters

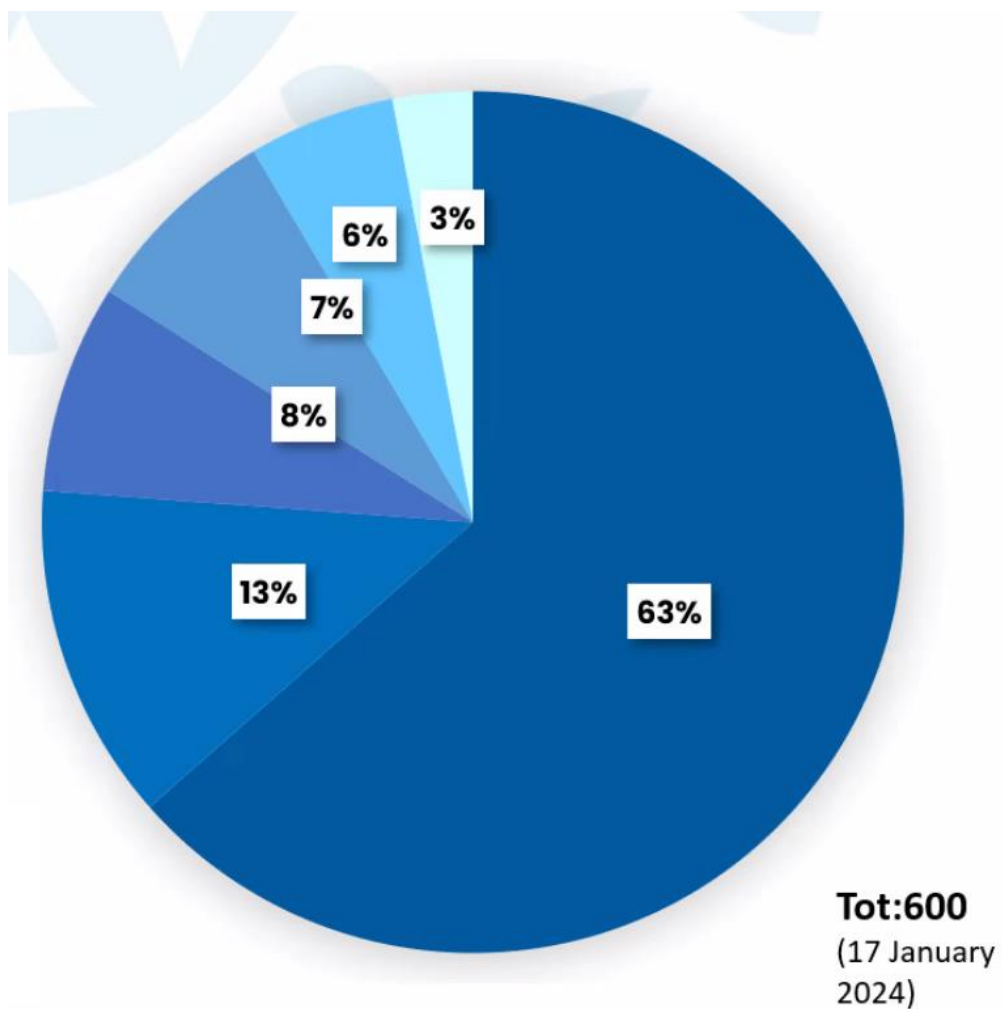
...supported by a secretariat

CoARA MEMBERSHIP



Currently 610 members (+ 82 „mere“ signatories of ARRA) (as of 19/2)

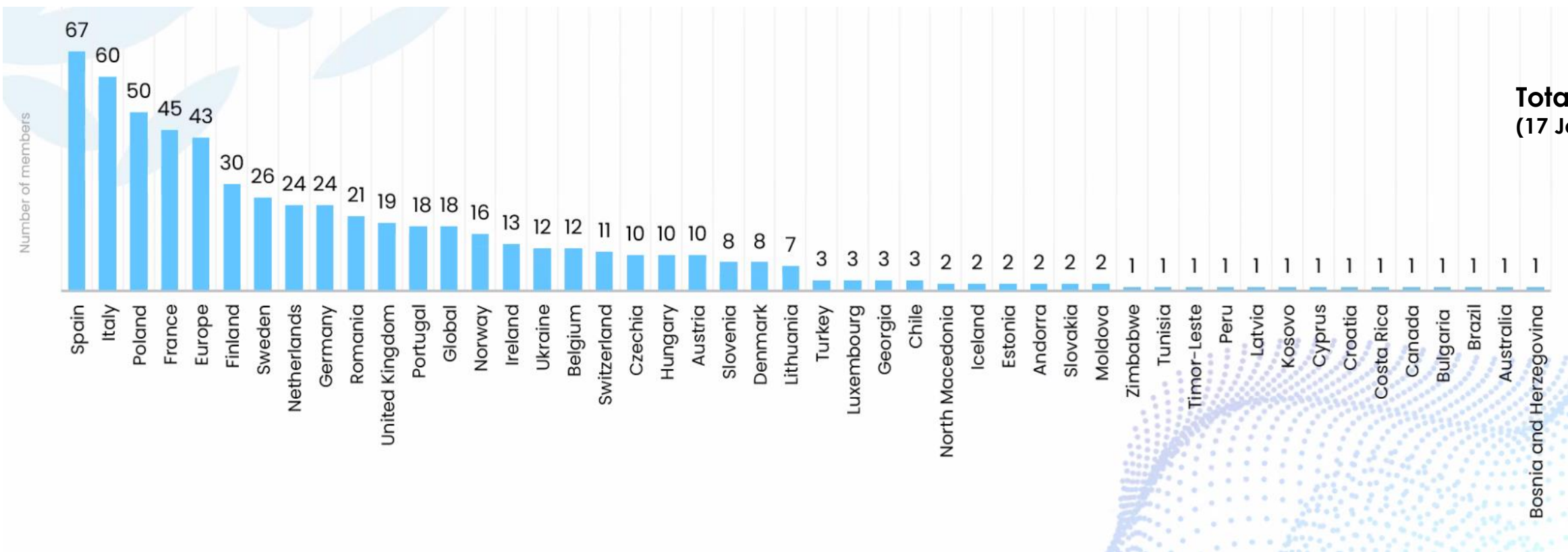
CoARA MEMBERSHIP BY TYPE OF ORGANISATION



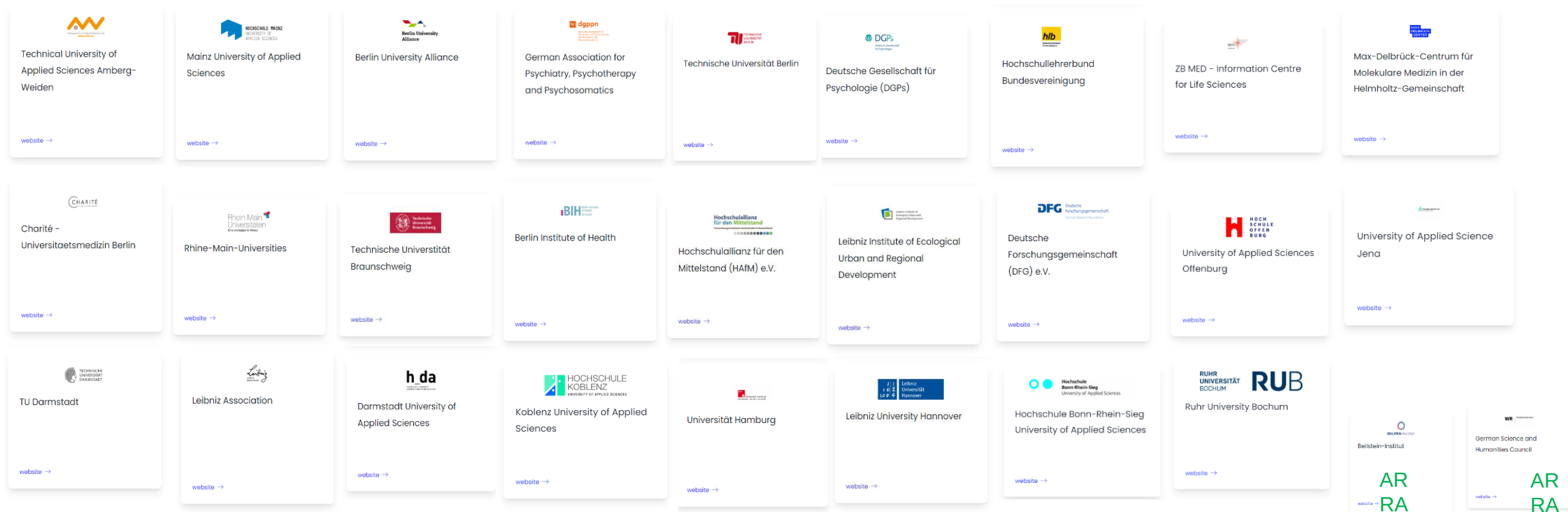
In descending order of total share:

- Universities and their associations
- Research centres, research infrastructures, and their associations
- Academies, learned societies, and their associations, and associations of researchers
- Public or private research funding organisations and their associations
- Other relevant non-for-profit organisations involved with research assessment, and their associations
- National/regional authorities or agencies that implement some form of research assessment and their associations

CoARA MEMBERSHIP BY COUNTRY



German members of CoARA





Thank you for your interest!

Further information

- ▶ DFG CoARA e-mail inbox: coara@dfg.de
- ▶ DFG Publication System e-mail inbox: publikationswesen@dfg.de
- ▶ on DFG: <https://www.dfg.de>
- ▶ on DFG's funding: <https://www.dfg.de/foerderatlas>
- ▶ on DFG funded projects: <https://www.dfg.de/gepris>
- ▶ on the German research landscape: <https://gerit.org>

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- Leitfaden für die Antragstellung - Projektanträge [09/22]: https://www.dfg.de/formulare/54_01/54_01_de.pdf
- Beschreibung des Vorhabens - Antragsskizze Forschungsgruppe [09/22]: https://www.dfg.de/formulare/53_20_elan/53_20_de_elan.rtf